

Challenge Write-Up Template

Instructions: Copy this template for every challenge you submit. Fill in every section — a write-up that only shows the final flag without explanation will not receive full credit. Delete these italicized instruction lines before submitting.

Challenge Information

Student Name	Facon, Janna Mae L.
Section / Class	BSIT- 3G
Challenge Name	bytemancy 0
Category	General Skills
Points / Difficulty	Easy
Date Solved	8/12/2026
Flag Format Given	PicoCTF{...}

1. Challenge Description

Restate the challenge in your own words: what were you given, and what were you asked to find or do? Do not simply copy-paste the original prompt.

The challenge required connecting to a remote server using **Netcat (nc)** and responding to the character-conversion request given by the server. The server asked for the ASCII decimal value **101** repeated three times, written side-by-side with no spaces. The goal was to determine which characters those decimal values represented and send the correct response to obtain the flag.

2. Initial Analysis / Reconnaissance

What did you check first? What did file, strings, a webpage view-source, or another first look tell you? What category did you decide this was, and why?

First, I checked the challenge description and identified that this was a basic General Skills challenge involving Netcat and ASCII conversion. I connected to the provided server using Netcat and read the message displayed by the server. It instructed me to send ASCII decimal 101, 101, 101 side-by-side with no spaces. I then determined that the ASCII decimal value 101 represents the lowercase letter “e.” Since the value 101 appeared three times, the correct characters were “e,”

“e,” and “e.” Following the instruction to place them side-by-side without spaces, I entered eee into the server. The server accepted the response and provided the correct flag.

3. Tools and Commands Used

List every tool/command you used, in the order you used them, and what each one told you.

Tool / Command	What it was used for	Result / Output
nc candy-mountain.picoctf.net 61613	Connected to the ByteMancy 0 challenge server using Netcat.	The server displayed the ByteMancy challenge and requested ASCII decimal 101, 101, 101, sideby-side with no spaces.
ASCII decimal conversion	Converted the decimal value 101 into its corresponding ASCII character.	101 = e
eee	Sent the three converted characters to the server with no spaces.	The server accepted the answer and returned the flag.

4. Solution Walkthrough

Explain your reasoning step by step — not just what you typed, but why you tried it and what you concluded from the result. Include screenshots, code snippets, or command output where useful. A reader who has not seen the challenge should be able to follow your logic and arrive at the same answer.

Step 1

The first step I did was read the challenge description carefully. I noticed that the challenge was categorized under **General Skills** and that the description said, “Can you conjure the right bytes?” It also mentioned that the program’s source code could be downloaded. The hint stated that solving the challenge with a one-liner would help with the next challenge in the series. From this, I understood that the challenge would likely involve working with bytes or ASCII characters and using a command-line tool.

bytemancy 0

General Skills Easy

by LT 'syreal' Jones · picoCTF 2026

Can you conjure the right bytes? The program's source code can be downloaded [here](#).

INSTANCE 1

Launch Instance

Additional details appear once you launch your instance.

HINTS 1

- 1 Solving this with a one-liner will help with the next challenge in this series

Step 2

Next, I launched the challenge instance and connected to the provided server using Netcat. I used the command `nc candymountain.picoctf.net 61613`. After connecting, the server displayed the ByteMancy 0 challenge and gave me the instruction to send ASCII decimal 101, 101, 101, side-by-side, with no spaces. This told me that I needed to convert the decimal values into their corresponding ASCII characters before sending my answer.

```
faconjannamae-academy@webshell:~$ nc candymountain.picoctf.net 61613
[ BYTEMANCY-0 ]
Send me ASCII DECIMAL 101, 101, 101, side-by-side, no space.
=> eee
picoCTF{pr1n74813_ch4r5_184029cd}
^C
faconjannamae-academy@webshell:~$
```

Step 3

I then converted the ASCII decimal value 101 into the lowercase letter e. Since the server requested 101 three times and instructed me to put them side-by-side with no spaces, I entered eee into the terminal. The server accepted my answer and displayed the flag `picoCTF{pr1n74813_ch4r5_184029cd}`. After obtaining the flag, I copied it and submitted it in the FLAG field of the ByteMancy 0 challenge page. The website confirmed that the submission was correct by displaying “Correct flag!”, which verified that I had successfully completed the challenge.

The screenshot shows the bytemancy CTF challenge interface on the left and a terminal window on the right. The interface includes a 'Launch Instance' button, a 'Hints' section with a 'Reveal hint' button, and a 'Flag' section with a text input field containing 'picoCTF{pr1n74813_ch4r5_184029cd}' and a 'Submit' button. The terminal window shows the user logging into the Cylab Security Academy webshell, running 'nc sandy-mountain.picoctf.net 81611', and then running 'picoCTF{pr1n74813_ch4r5_184029cd}' to submit the flag.

5. Flag

picoCTF{pr1n74813_ch4r5_184029cd}

6. Key Concept / What I Learned

In 2-4 sentences, name the underlying security concept or vulnerability class this challenge taught (e.g. "weak RSA exponent," "reflected XSS," "stack buffer overflow"). This is the part of the write-up most worth remembering after the flag is submitted.

This challenge taught me the basics of **ASCII encoding and byte-to-character conversion**. I learned that decimal values such as 101 can represent characters in the ASCII table, where 101 corresponds to the letter e. I also learned how Netcat can be used to communicate with a remote challenge server and how understanding byte representations can help solve cybersecurity challenges.

7. References

List any external resource you consulted beyond course materials (a tool's documentation, a technique explainer, a similar public write-up). It is normal and expected to use references — just cite them.

<https://youtu.be/pZmlq5JwtA?si=apZAQk9CNEVg6MEp>
